

# MARCELO RONDON

## PRODUCT DESIGNER

🌐 Portland, Oregon 🌐

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## ABOUT

Product designer focused on design systems, technical prototyping, and frontend-aware UX. I prototype the uncertain parts in code before teams commit to build, so product decisions ship with behavior, constraints, and handoff intent already worked out. Most recently I designed and shipped Ghosted, an AI job-application product built so the model stays bounded and every output is code-validated.

## EXPERIENCE

### Asheville Dispensary

2022 – Present

#### PRODUCT DESIGN LEAD / DESIGN ENGINEER

Asheville, NC (Remote)

- Own product design across web, print, and packaging, anchored by a Figma design system that keeps the brand coherent as the product line grows.
- Designed and built an internal asset-management tool in React, TypeScript, and Tailwind CSS that gives marketing and operations one place to find, manage, and preserve brand assets.
- Design and ship reusable UI components into WordPress through custom PHP and JavaScript plugins, closing the gap between mockups and production.
- Partner with marketing and operations to turn ambiguous requests into scoped, shipped product surfaces.

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### VegAvengers Marketing

2025 – Present

#### PRODUCT DESIGNER / DESIGN ENGINEER

Freelance project

- Designed and shipped the organization's content platform on Payload CMS: content model, editorial dashboard, and publish workflow, now run day-to-day by two non-technical editors.
- Built an AI freshness checker as Payload jobs that verifies festival data against primary sources and proposes corrections as drafts, so nothing goes live without editor approval.
- Designed and built the public discovery experience with flexible search across festivals and sanctuaries, served from the CMS with graceful fallbacks so an outage never breaks the site.

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### Cello.Design

2022 – Present

#### INDEPENDENT PRODUCT DESIGNER

Independent product design and accessibility practice. Selected engagements:

- The Green Phial: redesigned and maintained the WordPress storefront, translating brand direction into responsive, accessible front-end implementation with improved performance and SEO.
- Accessibility consulting: improved WCAG 2.1 compliance for multiple organizations, including River Phoenix Center for Peacebuilding, covering screen-reader behavior, keyboard navigation, and performance.
- Legal Impact for Chickens: built secure internal tooling for data-management workflows, handling confidential materials with discretion.
- Ghosted: designed and built an AI-assisted job-application product – a Go terminal prototype rewritten into a shipped Next.js/TypeScript web app, where deterministic code does the work and a single bounded, code-validated model call writes the prose; 744 tests.

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**Mantera Advertising Agency**  
**SENIOR BRAND DESIGNER****2021 – 2022**

Remote

- Designed campaign and marketing materials for retail clients under tight deadlines.
- Worked directly with clients through fast iteration cycles, clarifying goals and constraints while protecting quality and delivery dates.

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**Success Academy Charter Schools**  
**LEARNING EXPERIENCE DESIGNER / TEACHER****2020 – 2021**

New York, NY (Remote)

- Designed remote learning experiences for ELA and math using structured learning frameworks.
- Produced educational content and visual aids, applying design thinking to improve comprehension and engagement.

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**The Fine Print Magazine**  
**VISUAL STORYTELLING LEAD / PHOTO EDITOR****2017 – 2019**

Gainesville, FL

- Led a team of photographers and directed visual coverage for editorial stories and events.
- Developed visual direction for fundraising events, using photography and design to improve visibility and engagement.

**SKILLS**

**HTML** **CSS** **JAVASCRIPT** **TYPESCRIPT** **REACT** **TAILWIND** **GIT** **WORDPRESS** **PHP** **MYSQL** **FIGMA** **PHOTOSHOP**  
**ILLUSTRATOR** **AFTER EFFECTS** **PREMIERE** **PYTHON** **GO**

**PROJECTS****Ghosted****2026**

Designed and built an AI-assisted job-application workspace – from a Go terminal prototype to a shipped web product where deterministic code does the work and one bounded model call writes the prose.

- Rewrote a Go TUI prototype into a live Next.js/TypeScript web product with posting capture, deterministic fit scoring, and ATS-validated PDF export
- Designed the 'minimum viable intelligence' architecture: code parses, scores, and validates; the model only writes prose, checked against a 180-word cap, a banned-phrase list, and CV-grounded honesty flags
- Built a triage review UI (accept, reject, edit) and targeted revision so generated material is edited from, never pasted over
- Shipped to real testers on an invite-gated shared subscription, folding feedback into a synchronous double-fire guard and tighter layouts
- Backed by 744 tests across a pure-TypeScript core and a Next.js app

**PRODUCT DESIGN** **AI PRODUCT DESIGN** **TYPESCRIPT** **NEXT.JS** **REACT** **DESIGN SYSTEMS** **PROTOTYPING**  
**HUMAN-IN-THE-LOOP AI**

**EDUCATION****University of Florida**  
**VISUAL JOURNALISM & COMMUNICATIONS****2016 – 2019**

Minor: Digital Arts &amp; Sciences